

from over the wire; RSA 2048 is a long story anyway.

Prevention is better than cure

What can you do?

To avert invasion is always more difficult than to avoid it. But what can a normal user like you and me do? Well, basically nothing except prevent ignorance. Allow us to explain that sentence again. One of the biggest attack methods that can be used against any system connected to a network is DDoS.

Since DDoS requires a zombie computer army, the first measure you can take is to protect your computer from being zombified. If someone sitting remotely can control your computer then it is certainly bad news for you. There are a lot of other problems but from the cyber warfare viewpoint, your computer could be used for attacking another computer. If the target system is not built for very high traffic, then less than a dozen computers can be used in a DoS attack. Once again the international nature of the Internet can work against you. For e.g. if someone sitting in a foreign country takes control of your computer and uses it to launch DoS/DDoS attack on one of the critical servers of your own country, you can get into a lot of trouble.

At the same time, it is important for the employees working in government offices to protect their computers and laptops, especially for those who work with critical information. A lethargic approach to security by them can create backdoors to critical national data.

What can Governments do?

The first and foremost job that Governments can do is to create policies about the actions and steps to be taken when a cyber attack is detected. The second step that can be taken is to ensure that the ISPs throughout the country follow specific rules which can suppress attack methods like DDoS. Also, wherever possibilities exist, a separate and more secure network should be used for communication between two systems dealing with



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